

national policies of their respective countries on which they based their hopes for a better future for the world." Churchill and Roosevelt were soon joined by Russia and the governments of occupied Europe: Belgium, Greece, the Netherlands, Czechoslovakia, Luxembourg, Norway, Poland, Yugoslavia, and representatives from France.

Although the Atlantic Charter had no legal standing, it pledged cooperation to ensure peace in

times to come and to abandon the use of force. This pledge right at the height of the war, with support from the US for the first time, was a great inspiration for occupied countries.

At a meeting in the White House in December that year, just days after Japan's attack on Pearl Harbor, Roosevelt suggested to Churchill that the Allies call themselves the United Nations. Churchill agreed, noting that the phrase came from Lord Byron's

poem *Childe Harold's Pilgrimage*. As the war progressed, more countries signed up to the Declaration of United Nations, agreeing to the principles set out by the Atlantic Charter. By 1945, the total number had risen to 47 nations. At a conference at Dumbarton Oaks near Washington, DC, in 1944, delegates from China, Russia, the US, and the UK worked through proposals to build an organization to succeed the League

The structure of the UN

